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Closures set for street near South Station

Boston, MBTA reach deal to manage fans, traffic during World Cup games

By Danny McDonald
and Chris Serres

GLOBE STAFF

After weeks of tense negotiations, Boston and state transportation officials have struck a deal to manage traffic outside South Station for crowds queueing to go the World Cup, ending a dispute that had underlined the chaotic local planning around the huge sporting event.

Under the deal, Summer Street near South Station will be closed for the first and third matches at Gillette Stadium in Foxborough, scheduled for 9 p.m. Saturday, June 13, and 6 p.m. Friday, June 19, and will be closed for the later matches slated for 4:30 p.m. Monday, June 29, and 4 p.m. Thursday, July 9.

For matches that will held on June 16, June 23, and June 26, all of which start in late afternoon or ear-

ly evening, the westbound side of Summer, a main thoroughfare that brings traffic into downtown Boston from the Seaport, will remain open to cars.

On those dates, the direction of travel for vehicles on Summer Street “will be coordinated based on the demands of the respective day and time,” with security officials making decisions “as needed in the interest of public safety,” authorities said. That may include additional temporary traffic restrictions and lane closures to accommodate crowd management.

The MBTA and the city of Boston will also review the Summer Street closures following each match, officials said.

“Consistent with our usual process for planning large scale events, we are pleased that our City and State teams have developed a shared plan for Summer Street that will ensure public safety, efficient access, and clear coordination,” said Mayor Michelle Wu in a statement on Tuesday.

At a news conference at the train station in Foxborough near Gillette

WORLD CUP, Page A6

Democrats warn ballot question is off mark

Say Mass. revenue would take a huge hit if income tax rate were cut to 4%

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

Democrats on Beacon Hill sent a clear message to business leaders on Tuesday: Mess with the state’s income tax rate, and you’ll pay for it in lost tax benefits down the road.

The warning, codified in a spending bill lawmakers are expected to approve this week, was triggered by a ballot question pushed by some elements of the business community that would reduce the rate to 4 percent, from 5 percent. If passed by voters this November, then Massachusetts would not implement state-level tax changes that mirror those at the federal level under President Trump’s major policy legislation signed into law last July.

Lawmakers have cast the proposed income tax reduction as a catastrophic blow to public services because it could eventually reduce annual tax collections by as much as \$5 billion.

“We certainly know that it would have some potential major impacts on revenue over a period of time,” Representative Aaron Michlewitz, the House’s budget chief, said Tuesday of the federal tax changes and the ballot question. “We felt we had to just make sure that we were protecting our revenue resources a little bit tighter. By doing this measure, I think we are doing that at least for the short term.”

INCOME TAX, Page A5

Cambridge tries to thread needle on kids’ screen usage

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

How much screen time is too much? Especially at school?

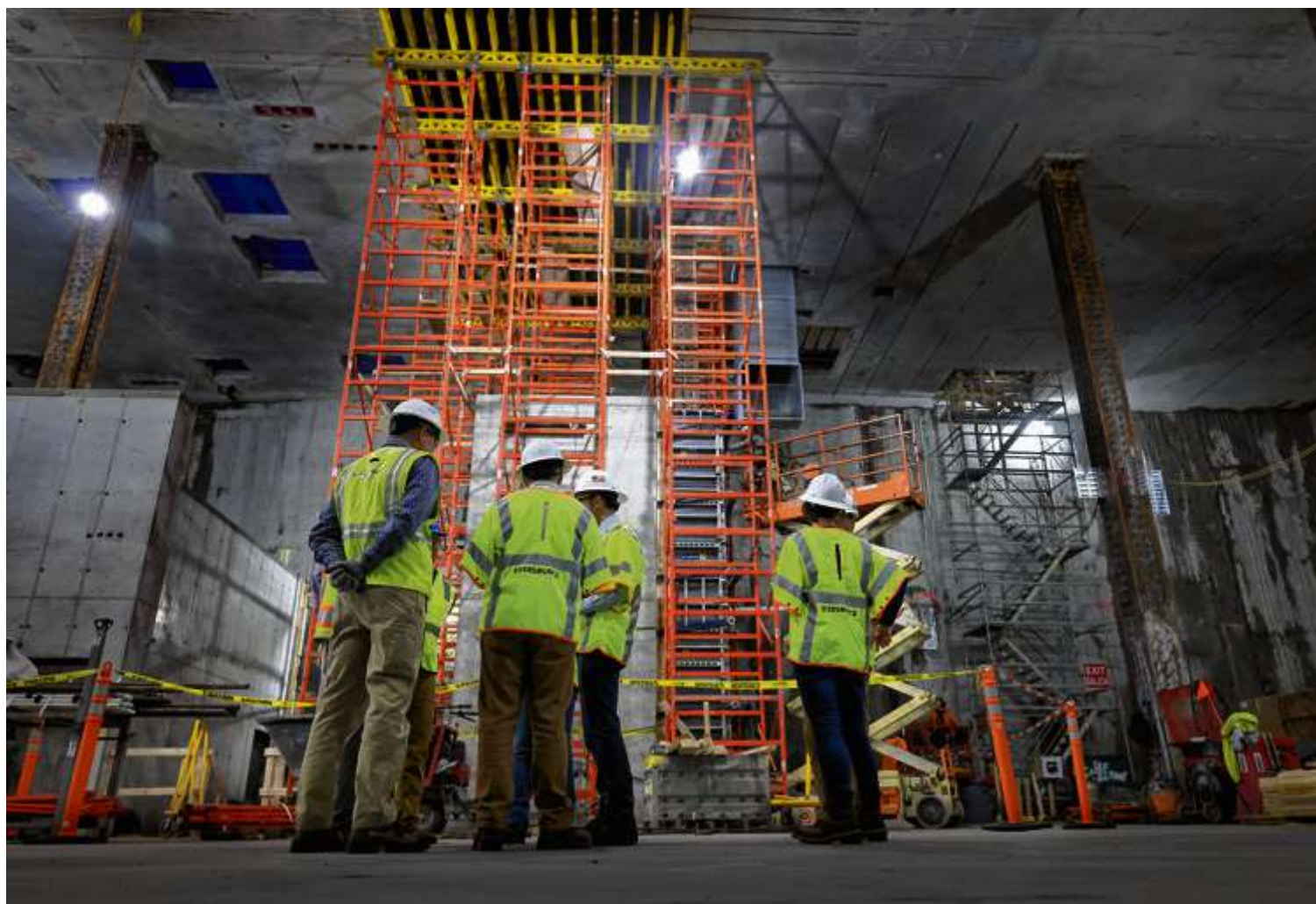
Many parents fretting about the hold technology has over their kids’ every moment now say the less, the better.

In Cambridge, where debate over the merits of screens has been especially pitched this year, school officials have batted around the idea of a ban, at least until third grade.

Now a new study offers a glimpse, however limited, at the role screen time is playing in a child’s life during the hours when they’re at school, be it 6-year-olds tapping away on math games during class, or teenagers hacking their Chromebooks to text their friends.

It is just a small portion of the life of a child, who may spend hours a day engaging with a screen of one kind or another. It did not, for example, address the use of cellphones, a primary way many kids absorb screen-based content. Nor did it assess the district’s decision last year to ban the use of the phones during school days — and what impact that might be having on how kids use, or mis-

SCREENS, Page A7



PHOTOS BY LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

A tour group inspected the bottom level of the substation project, which is expected to be completed in a few years.

JOURNEY TO THE CENTER OF KENDALL SQUARE



Jeff Lowenberg, senior vice president of development for BXP, which is building in a key swath of Kendall Square.

Deep, deep, deep down, a massive electrical substation is taking shape

By Joshua Miller
GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — On a recent Thursday, I was in a wildly disorienting spot: several stories under — yes, under — the high-tech heart of Kendall Square, walking around what

REPORTER’S NOTEBOOK

will be the country’s largest underground electrical substation. There, I decided to nerd out with some of the top minds at Eversource and try to really understand what the heck they were doing.

Amid the dizzying distortion of the scale — you could look way up to ground level through a gigantic opening, and see part of Cambridge’s tallest building, an under-construction 450-foot-tall residential tower, stretching into the sky — Eversource’s Ken Roberts offered the basic background on what brought us here.

The electric system is made up of two major systems,

KENDALL SQUARE, Page A6

Female doctors more apt to leave medicine

Inequities such as pay persist

By Kara Miller
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

When Dr. Cornelia Griggs, a pediatric surgeon at Massachusetts General Hospital, was in training, she got lots of advice: Be careful what specialty you go into. Consider what life is going to be like when you’re a parent.

Her husband — who is also a surgeon — “didn’t get that advice,” says Griggs, 43. “Our profession and how we train was structured and designed in an era where it was mostly men going through residency.

They mostly had partners who could follow them wherever they landed in the match, and the makeup of our profession looks very different now.”

Griggs, who spoke personally and not for her employer, says, “We are experiencing a backlash to a surge of women who entered procedural fields” — including gastroenterology, interventional radiology, and surgery. And she has chronicled explicit and implicit bias that female surgeons across the country experience. “Now we represent a real economic threat to the boys.”

But the problems for female doctors aren’t confined

DOCTORS, Page A7



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

IN A GOOD POSITION: A day after being acquired by the Patriots, wide receiver A.J. Brown was ready to go Tuesday at his first practice with the team. It’s been a dream of his to play for New England, he said. **C1.**

Embrace Boston, the group behind the monument to the Kings on Boston Common, has acquired two buildings to form a hub for racial justice. **B1.**

Acting Attorney General Todd Blanche said he’s withdrawing a proposal to create a \$1.8 billion fund amid a revolt among Republicans. **A2.**

Novo Marketplace, a new food court in Allston, offers a trip through Asia and beyond. **G1.**

Looking up

Wednesday: Very pleasant. High 73-78. Low 58-63.

Thursday: Hotter. High 82-87. Low 62-67. Sunrise: 5:09 Sunset: 8:16

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.

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